06-25 第一篇

From Silkworm to Silk: A Ancient Craft

Silk is one of the world's oldest and most valued textiles. It comes from the cocoons（茧）of silkworms—the caterpillars of the silk moth. For over 5,000 years, China has been the centre of silk production, and the Silk Road once carried this precious fabric to Europe and beyond. [1] In other words, silk connects ancient history, delicate craftsmanship, and global trade in a single thread. Today, silk is still prized for its softness, shine, and strength, though making it remains a labour-intensive process.

Silkworms go through a remarkable transformation. [2] They hatch from tiny eggs and eat only mulberry leaves for about a month, growing quickly. When they are ready, they spin a cocoon around themselves—a single thread can be hundreds of metres long. Inside the cocoon, the caterpillar turns into a moth. To harvest the silk, the cocoons are boiled before the moth breaks out; this keeps the thread unbroken. The threads from several cocoons are then twisted together to make a strong silk fibre. Each step—from feeding the worms to unwinding the cocoons—requires care and skill.

Silk production has shaped cultures and economies. [3] In ancient China, silk was so valuable that it was used as currency and given as gifts to rulers of other lands. The techniques of silk-making were kept secret for a long time. Silk cloth was worn by emperors and nobles and used in important ceremonies. Later, when the Silk Road opened, silk became a symbol of luxury and exchange between East and West. Even today, silk clothing and accessories are associated with elegance and special occasions.

Modern silk production faces new challenges. [4] Natural silk is still made in traditional ways in many regions, but synthetic fibres can now imitate the look and feel of silk at a lower cost. Some people worry about the welfare of silkworms—boiling cocoons kills the moths inside—and look for alternative methods. At the same time, efforts are being made to protect mulberry farms and preserve traditional silk-weaving skills. Balancing tradition, ethics, and market demand is an ongoing discussion in the silk industry.

[5] From the silkworm's cocoon to the finest garments, it represents centuries of human ingenuity. The next time you touch a piece of silk, think about the journey it has taken—and the countless hands that have helped create it.

选项

A. In other words, silk connects ancient history, delicate craftsmanship, and global trade in a single thread. B. They hatch from eggs, eat mulberry leaves, then spin cocoons; the threads inside are harvested by boiling the cocoons. C. Silk was once used as currency, kept as a secret, and later spread along the Silk Road as a symbol of luxury. D. Synthetic

fibres can imitate silk, and some people question the ethics of traditional methods—the industry is evolving. E. Silk remains a bridge between the past and the present. F. For example, wedding dresses are often made of silk in many cultures.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：概括丝绸的历史、工艺与贸易价值。空前描述"Silk...oldest, most valued textiles...from cocoons of silkworms...over 5,000 years China centre of production...Silk Road carried to Europe and beyond"，空后说明"Today silk still prized for softness, shine, strength...making remains labour-intensive"。A选项"In other words, silk connects ancient history, delicate craftsmanship, and global trade in a single thread"（换言之，丝绸在一根丝线中连接了古老历史、精妙工艺与全球贸易）中"In other words"概括空前，"ancient history...craftsmanship...global trade"与空前 5000 years、Silk Road、今日价值精准呼应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：蚕的生命周期与取丝过程。空前提出"Silkworms go through a remarkable transformation"，空后详述"Hatch from tiny eggs...eat only mulberry leaves about a month...grow quickly...spin cocoon around themselves...single thread hundreds of metres...inside caterpillar turns into moth...To harvest: cocoons boiled before moth breaks out...keeps thread unbroken...threads from several cocoons twisted together...strong silk fibre...Each step requires care and skill"。B选项"They hatch from eggs, eat mulberry leaves, then spin cocoons; the threads inside are harvested by boiling the cocoons"（它们从卵孵化，吃桑叶，然后吐丝结茧；茧内丝线通过煮茧获取）中"hatch from eggs...eat mulberry...spin cocoons...threads...harvested by boiling"与空后内容完美对应，逻辑紧密。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：丝绸在历史中的文化经济地位。空前提出"Silk production has shaped cultures and economies"，空后描述"In ancient China silk so valuable used as currency, gifts to rulers...techniques kept secret...silk cloth worn by emperors, nobles, important ceremonies...Silk Road opened...symbol of luxury, exchange East and West...Today silk clothing, accessories...elegance, special occasions"。C选项"Silk was once used as currency, kept as a secret, and later spread along the Silk Road as a symbol of luxury"（丝绸曾用作货币、被保

密，后来沿丝绸之路传播成为奢侈的象征）中"currency...kept secret...Silk Road...symbol of luxury"与空后表述精准对应，衔接自然。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：当代丝绸产业的挑战与演变。空前提出"Modern silk production faces new challenges"，空后列举"Natural silk still made traditionally...but synthetic fibres imitate look, feel at lower cost...Some worry about silkworm welfare—boiling kills moths—look for alternatives...efforts protect mulberry farms, preserve weaving skills...Balancing tradition, ethics, market demand...ongoing discussion"。D选项"Synthetic fibres can imitate silk, and some people question the ethics of traditional methods—the industry is evolving"（合成纤维可以模仿丝绸，有人质疑传统方法的伦理——产业正在演变）中"synthetic imitate...question ethics...industry evolving"与空后内容完美对应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与丝绸的古今纽带。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后为"From the silkworm's cocoon to the finest garments, it represents centuries of human ingenuity. The next time you touch a piece of silk, think about the journey it has taken—and the countless hands that have helped create it."。E选项"Silk remains a bridge between the past and the present"（丝绸仍是过去与现在之间的桥梁）用"bridge...past and present"总结主题，"remains"与空后"centuries...journey...countless hands"形成呼应，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, wedding dresses are often made of silk in many cultures.**：涉及婚纱常用丝绸，易被误填[3]。但F以"For example"引出婚庆用途，而空[3]讨论的是丝绸在古代的经济文化地位（货币、保密、贵族、丝绸之路、奢侈品），F的"wedding dresses"属于当代婚俗应用，与"currency...kept secret...emperors...Silk Road"的历史论述焦点不同；且空[3]已涵盖"special occasions"，F仅为其中一例，论述层次较窄。F属"主题相关但论述层次错位"型干扰。